

Sunday, July 8th (Morning)

My father had many gifts. His work ethic was peerless. He was a visionary and a romantic; he simply saw what others could not. He saw “yes” where others saw “no”. For much of his life, he employed those gifts in his own ventures and for his own ends. He was a serial entrepreneur, and all of the aforementioned gifts contributed to his success.

The Village of Los Ranchos was the vehicle where my father employed his great gifts to public ends -- to serve you. The results speak for themselves. He treated the part-time position as a full-life effort. He delivered to Los Ranchos an identity and unique sense of place. He also ran his administration like a business, resulting in incredible fiscal health. This place, the Agri-Nature Center is a terrific embodiment of both. Though the ultimate testament to his success is that you elected him to four consecutive 4-year terms.

In his survey *Democracy in America*, Alexis de Tocqueville declared that America’s society could only function because it was a “nation of joiners”. In an era of deep cynicism and mistrust, my father had a more innocent calculus: he simply saw a job, and then did a job. And then he saw how to do that job better.

A small community issue would snowball into a full-blown Mayorship. After he won by a slim margin, with his relentless pragmatism, he ultimately became loved by the entire community. I agree with de Tocqueville that this focused joining is the lynchpin of our American exceptionalism, and my father modeled it in spades.

Beyond this simple joining, his romanticism in concert with his work ethic made my Dad was a sort of World Builder. One of my professors at Business School speaks of leadership as a kind of responsibility to influence the reality of those you lead. My father did this.

He envisioned a more distinct, healthier Los Ranchos, before others did, and he could not rest until his vision matched the reality in front of him. Similarly, my father grew frustrated when he witnessed others settle for a Los Ranchos lesser than the one he envisioned in his mind -- or when they used Albuquerque on their receipts.

Like with all my father’s projects, he brought his whole heart to bare on this village. He fell in love with this place, with you. He took emails and phonecalls for what others would consider minutiae because he cared so deeply about what this Village was to its people. Even as his tenure grew long in the tooth, he could still get fired up about community issues.

My father gave this village all of himself. He forged a unique identity, and carefully planned out far greater financial security. The Village of Los Ranchos, in exchange, gave my father a sense of identity. (He would include “Mayor” in his name on Facebook.) It gave him an outlet for his many, well-matured talents and vision, and a kind of validation for said talents and vision. It was a kind of pinnacle of his career. And it was a beautiful, mutual exchange.

And so it is a great honor to see his name on a substantial piece of this community. I intend to bring my children to this place, and tell stories of his tenure. Even as his name will be emblazoned on this building -- and this would have been a source of tremendous pride for him, and will be for our family -- I will close with a quote from Pericles: "What you leave behind is not what is engraved in stone monuments, but what is woven into the lives of others."

Thank you.